

Fleet Street in the 1600's

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THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

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In the 1600s, Fleet Street was very busy. Many people worked there, like builders, printers, lawyers, and rich people. Some women ran shops and coffee houses.

The street was dirty and not safe. The Fleet River was full of waste. There was crime, and sicknesses like the plague could kill people. Winters were very cold, and smoke from coal made the air black.

Fleet Street was also exciting. It was the main road between Westminster and the City. People could see big events, like coronations, public gatherings, and even executions. During the Civil War, people sold many political papers, and women joined protests.

For fun, there were inns, taverns, and theatres. People could watch plays, meet visitors, or see strange animals. Some old places, like the Old Cheshire Cheese pub, still show what life was like long ago.

